

FLI SCI Social Sciences

📪 Contact Information & Hours

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📋Curriculum Description

The **Social Sciences Track** of **FLI SCI (First-Generation, Low-Income Scholars Initiative)** focuses on helping students explore social science research, develop data literacy and build confidence as future scholars. Through a series of interactive workshops, mentoring sessions, guest speaker series, enrichment activities, and individual projects, you will learn how to transform curiosity into meaningful research questions and evidence-based insights.

To accomplish this, students will complete a set of deliverables—including annotated bibliographies, abstracts and paper drafts—that culminate in the creation of a publishable two-page research brief for the AGEP Science Today Bulletin.

Students will also create deliverables that connect social science to the general public, such as journal article summaries and podcast reflections, highlighting the importance of making research accessible and engaging beyond academia.

🔐 Learning Objectives

💡 **Identify and Apply Research Methods**
Identify the fields, methods, and applications in social science. Distinguish between qualitative and quantitative approaches and identify independent and dependent variables within a study.

📊 **Understand and Analyze Data**
Create researchable questions and testable ideas. Use descriptive statistics and basic visualization tools to interpret and present research findings.

📣 **Communicate Research**
Write clear, concise abstracts and research briefs. Practice public engagement through presentations, podcasts, or article summaries.

✅ **Build Professional and Academic Confidence**
Strengthen academic writing, communication and networking skills to prepare for undergraduate research and future scholarly opportunities.

🏆 Deliverables

Any assignment marked with a "📌" emoji indicates a deliverable that will help you prepare your manuscript for submission to the AGEP Science Today Bulletin. For more information about the journal's guidelines, formatting, and due dates, please visit here:

🔗 https://grad.msu.edu/agep/bulletin

These assignments will not receive a numerical grade. Instead, you will receive constructive and detailed feedback aimed at helping you strengthen your research skills and move confidently toward publication.

All feedback will be provided within one week after each submission deadline.

📏 Formatting Rules

Please format all written deliverables according to APA style and the following rules (consistent formatting helps you build professional research habits and prepares you for academic writing):

- Font & Size: 12 pt.—Times New Roman
- Spacing: Double-spaced
- Margins: 1 inch on all sides
- Page Numbers: Bottom right corner

🏷️ Descriptions and Due Dates

Aa Deliverable	Description	Due Date
📌 Annotated Bibliography Draft #1	Identify at least 5–7 scholarly sources relevant to their research topic and write short annotations summarizing each source's question, methods and findings. This first draft should emphasize proper citation and paraphrasing.	@November 14, 2025
📌 Annotated Bibliography Draft #2 Due	This is a revised version of the first draft, incorporating feedback to strengthen summaries. I want you to think about how your sources connect to your research question. This should build a stronger literature foundation for your eventual paper. 7-10 scholarly sources	@November 28, 2025
📌 Abstract Draft #1 Due	Draft a short 150–200-word abstract that outlines your research question, method and preliminary (or expected findings).	@December 12, 2025
📌 Research Paper Draft #1 Due	Submit the first version of your 2-page manuscript modeled after the *AGEP Science Today Bulletin.* The draft must include an introduction, methods and discussion sections.	@December 19, 2025
📌 PowerPoint Draft #1 Due	Create a PowerPoint or Canva presentation summarizing your research question, methods and early results. Play close attention to your visuals and practice your presentation flow.	@January 5, 2026
📌 PowerPoint Draft #2 Due	Incorporate mentor feedback into your presentation. Refine design, improve clarity, and timing to better prepare for your final presentations.	@January 19, 2026
📌 Abstract Draft #2 Due	A refined and polished version of your initial abstract, emphasizing precision, relevance to the research paper's argument and update your expected findings.	@January 26, 2026
📌 Research Paper Draft #2 Due	Submit a second iteration of your 2-page manuscript, focusing on improving thematic structure, refine logic flow, and start integrating evidence (tables, charts, etc.).	@February 2, 2026
📌 Research Paper Draft #3 Due	Ensure your writing meets professional formatting and citation standards. This draft should include your analysis of the results, a discussion of your paper, and future implications.	@February 16, 2026
📌 Research Paper Submission #1 Due	Submit a polished paper for internal review (your classmates) and mentor feedback (invited mentors). This version should be submission-ready and must follow all of the AGEP Science Today Bulletin guidelines.	@March 4, 2026
📌 Research Paper Submission #2 Due	Final submission of the student's manuscript to the AGEP Science Today Bulletin. Students must complete all revisions (from mentors and your peers). Please finalize formatting, figures and references.	@March 18, 2026
✍🏻 Summarize an APSR article Draft #1 Due	Read a short article from the American Political Science Review (APSR) or any political science journal of your choice and write a summary that identifies the research question, methods and findings.	@April 15, 2026
✍🏻 Summarize an APSR article Draft #2 Due	Revise your initial summary based on feedback, you also must follow the summary guidelines of the APSA Public Scholarship Program. (See Instructor)	@April 29, 2026
🎙️ Podcast Interview & Reflection Draft #1 Due	Students record a short podcast-style interview with a teacher, grad student or friend and talk about either (a) your FLI SCI project or (b) a social science topic	@May 6, 2026
🎙️ Podcast Interview & Reflection Draft #2 Due	Finalized podcast script with a 1-Page reflection discussing your experience.	@May 20, 2026

⌚Social Science Itemized Program Schedule

🚨 This course schedule provides a thorough list of weekly topics. If changes occur, I will let you know ahead of time.

Schedule

Session Name	Dates	Session Type	Key Words
🔭 What is Social Science?	@October 25, 2025	Lesson + Workshop	Introductions
🔬 How to Research?	@November 1, 2025	Lesson + Workshop	JSTOR, Google Scholar, Databases, Search Filtering
⚙️ Research Methods in the Social Sciences PART I	@November 8, 2025	Lesson + Workshop	Research Questions, Literature Review
⚙️ Research Methods in the Social Sciences PART II	@November 15, 2025	Lesson + Workshop	Variables, Hypothesis Testing, Data Analysis
📰 Anatomy of a Paper	@November 22, 2025	Lab	Abstract, Intro, Methods, Analysis, Discussion, References
🥳 BREAK:	@November 29, 2025	No Session	BREAK
📊 Data Visualization	@December 6, 2025	Lesson + Workshop	Tableau, Shapefiles, Google Earth
✍️ Data Storytelling	@December 14, 2019	Lesson + Workshop	Data Visualization Tools + Communication
👨‍🏫 Research Design Presentations	@December 20, 2025	Student Presentations	Literature Review, Theory, Gap, Hypotheses, Methods, Data, Limitations
❄️ Winter Break	@December 27, 2025	No Session	BREAK
❄️ Winter Break	@January 3, 2026	No Session	BREAK
⬜ Chalk Talk #1	@January 9, 2026	Student Presentations	Public Speaking, Research Design
🏙️ Town Hall	@January 17, 2026	Lab	Observe Grad Student Presentations, Notetaking
⬜ Chalk Talk #2	@January 24, 2026	Student Presentations	Public Speaking, Research Design
🌱 Ethics in Research	@January 31, 2026	Lesson + Workshop	IRB, Informed Consent, Positionality, Reflexivity
⬜ Chalk Talk #3	@February 7, 2026	Student Presentations	Public speaking, Research Design
🏙️ Town Hall	@February 14, 2026	Lab	Observe Grad Student Presentations, Notetaking
⬜ Chalk Talk #4	@February 21, 2026	Student Presentations	Public Speaking, Research Design
💬 Final Presentations	@February 28, 2026	Student Presentations	Public Speaking, Research Design
👥 Peer-review Paper: Workshop #1	@March 7, 2026	Guest Lecture	**Laura Uribe** PhD Candidate of Political Science at the University of California San Diego

Session Name	Dates	Session Type	Key Words
			Peer-Review w/PhD Students
👥 Peer-review Paper: Workshop #2	@March 14, 2026	Lab	Peer-Review Among Peers
📓 Submit to AGEP Science Today Bulletin	@March 21, 2026	📌 Final Assignment	Final Submission
🎒 Life & Research as an Undergrad Panel	@March 28, 2026	Guest Lecture	**Anamaria Acevedo Diaz** Undergraduate Psychology Student at the University of Central Florida **Andrea Arce Rodríguez** Undergraduate Forensic Science Student at the Inter American University of Puerto Rico—Aguadilla **Amanda P. Fonseca Irizarry** Undergraduate Biology Student at the Inter American University of Puerto Rico—Aguadilla
📣 Public Engagement in Social Sciences	@April 4, 2026	Lesson + Workshop	Political Science, Journal Review
👩🏻‍💼 Professionalization Workshop: Part I	@April 11, 2026	Lesson + Workshop	CV Building
👨🏻‍💼 Professionalization Workshop: Part II	@April 18, 2026	Lesson + Workshop	Elevator Pitch, LinkedIn Profile
🥳 BREAK: MPSA Conference	@April 25, 2026	No Session	BREAK
🚣🏻‍♀️ Applying for a Conference	@May 2, 2026	Lesson + Workshop	Abstract
💵 Grant Writing Workshop	@May 9, 2026	Guest Lecture	**Dr. Kaelyn Sanders** Assistant Professor, School of Criminology & Criminal Justice at Arizona State University
🍿 Media & Culture in the Social Sciences	@May 16, 2026	Lab	YouTube, Movies, Music
👩🏻‍🎤 Show & Tell	@May 23, 2026	Student Presentations	Present any artist, writer, film or non-academic topic that engages in social science
🍏 Saturday Lunch & Kahoot Game Quiz	@May 30, 2026	Fun	Bring your lunch. Kahoot quiz based on program objectives and lessons

⚠️ Late Assignments

Because this program focuses on growth and mentorship rather than grades, assignments will not receive point deductions for lateness. However, meeting deadlines is an important part of the research process and professional development. If you anticipate delays due to foreseen or unforeseen circumstances, **please communicate** with me in advance whenever possible. I understand that life happens — our goal is to support you in staying on track but also acknowledge you as a human being. Late submissions may receive delayed feedback or may not be included in peer-review sessions, which could impact your progress toward completing your research brief.

🚩 Plagiarism

You are encouraged to draw inspiration and information from books, articles, videos and other sources but it is essential to acknowledge where ideas come from using proper citation practices. Learning to cite sources correctly is an important skill for any scholar and helps you build credibility in your work. If you ever feel unsure about how to paraphrase, summarize or cite a source, ask your me for guidance before submitting your assignment. Our goal is to help you understand how to engage ethically with other people's research, not to penalize mistakes made in the learning process. Repeated or intentional use of others' work without credit will be treated as a teaching opportunity—you'll receive feedback from FLI SCI Program staff, me and a chance to revise your submission.

📆 Social Science Program Calendar

October 2025

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
			1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11
12	13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24	25 Welcome
26	27	28	29	30	31	

November 2025

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
						1 How to Research Workshop
2	3	4	5	6	7	8 Research Methods in the Social Sciences PART I
9	10	11	12	13	14 Annotated Bibliography Draft #1 Due	15 Research Methods in the Social Sciences PART II
16	17	18	19	20	21	22 Anatomy of a Paper
23	24	25	26	27	28 Annotated Bibliography Draft #2 Due	29 NO SESSION
30						

December 2025

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
	1	2	3	4	5	6 Data Visualization
7	8	9	10	11	12 Abstract Draft #1 Due	13 Data Storytelling
14	15	16	17	18	19 Research Paper Draft #1 Due	20 Research Design Presentations
21	22	23	24	25	26	27 NO SESSION
28	29	30	31			

January 2026

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
				1	2	3 NO SESSION
4	5 PowerPoint Draft #1 Due	6	7	8	9	10 Chalk Talk #1
11	12	13	14	15	16	17 Town Hall
18	19 PowerPoint Draft #2 Due	20	21	22	23	24 Chalk Talk #2
25	26 Abstract Draft #2 Due	27	28	29	30	31 Ethics in Research

February 2026

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
1	2 Research Paper Draft #2 Due	3	4	5	6	7 Chalk Talk #3
8	9	10	11	12	13	14 Town Hall
15	16 Research Paper Draft #3 Due	17	18	19	20	21 Chalk Talk #4
22	23	24	25	26	27	28 Final Presentations

March 2026

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
1	2	3	4 Research Paper Submission #1 Due	5	6	7 Peer-review Paper: Workshop #1
8	9	10	11	12	13	14 Peer-review Paper: Workshop #2
15	16	17	18 Research Paper Submission #2 Due	19	20	21 ⭐ **Submit to AGEP Science Today Bulletin**
22	23	24	25	26	27	28 Life & Research as an UndergraduatePanel
29	30	31				

April 2026

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
			1	2	3	4 Public Engagement in Social Sciences
5	6	7	8	9	10	11 Professionalization Workshop: Part I
12	13	14	15 Summarize an APSR article Draft #1 Due	16	17	18 Professionalization Workshop: Part II
19	20	21	22	23	24	25 NO SESSION
26	27	28	29 Summarize an APSR article Draft #2 Due	30		

May 2026

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
					1	2 Applying for a Conference
3	4	5	6 Podcast Interview & Reflection Draft #1 Due	7	8	9 Grant Writing Workshop
10	11	12	13	14	15	16 Media & Culture in the Social Sciences
17	18	19	20 Podcast Interview & Reflection Draft #2 Due	21	22	23 Show & Tell
24	25	26	27	28	29	30 Saturday Lunch & Kahoot Game Quiz